RATIONALISM

RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND → CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO → CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND → DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION → SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND → SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND CONNECTED 3-1-INFINITY SEQUENCE

STAGE 00

RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND CONNECTED 3-1-INFINITY SEQUENCE · CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD? · A PRIORI PRINCIPLES + INTUITION + DEDUCTION · SUBSTANCE, ATTRIBUTE, MODE AND SUFFICIENT EXPLANATION · GOD + MIND + BODY · INTERACTION PROBLEM · ONE GOD/NATURE · PARALLELISM + NECESSITY

CENTRAL QUESTION: CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD? → METHOD: a priori principles + intuition + deduction → METAPHYSICS: substance, attribute, mode and sufficient explanation → DESCARTES: God + mind + body → interaction problem → SPINOZA: one God/Nature → parallelism + necessity → individuality problem

SOURCE / DOCTRINE
- CENTRAL QUESTION: CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD?
- METHOD: a priori principles + intuition + deduction
- METAPHYSICS: substance, attribute, mode and sufficient explanation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM
- DESCARTES: God + mind + body → interaction problem
- SPINOZA: one God/Nature → parallelism + necessity → individuality problem
- LEIBNIZ: many monads → harmony + contingency → economy and evil problem

IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- MEMORY: substance 3-1-infinity; mind-body I-P-H.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A shared demand for intelligibility produces different systems because independence, simplicity and individuation are interpreted differently.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rationalism is unified by confidence in a priori reason but divided by the criterion of substance, which moves from Cartesian dualism through Spinozist monism to Leibnizian monadic pluralism.

01 CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO AND FIRST CERTAINTY

STAGE 01

CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO AND FIRST CERTAINTY · FOUR METHOD RULES · SIMPLE-TO-COMPLEX ORDER · COMPLETE REVIEW · SENSE ERROR · DREAM ARGUMENT · EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS SUSPEND EVERY BELIEF THAT CAN BE DOUBTED · I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK IMMEDIATE INTUITION

FOUR METHOD RULES: evidence → division → simple-to-complex order → complete review → SENSE ERROR → DREAM ARGUMENT → EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS suspend every belief that can be doubted → COGITO: I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK immediate intuition, not a syllogism → clear and distinct perception becomes the model → intuition supplies first principles; deduction orders consequences

SOURCE / DOCTRINE
- FOUR METHOD RULES: evidence → division → simple-to-complex order → complete review
- SENSE ERROR → DREAM ARGUMENT → EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS suspend every belief that can be doubted

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM
- COGITO: I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK immediate intuition, not a syllogism
- clear and distinct perception becomes the model

IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- intuition supplies first principles; deduction orders consequences
- LIMIT: present thinking is certain; enduring res cogitans needs further argument.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The attempt to doubt thinking existence performs the very thinking whose existence it tries to deny.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The cogito defeats radical doubt performatively; deception may falsify what is thought, but it cannot erase the occurrence and existence of the thinker while thinking.

02 CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND CIRCLE OBJECTION

STAGE 02

CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND CIRCLE OBJECTION · MATHEMATICS AND EXTERNAL RES EXTENSA · FACTITIOUS; OBJECTIVE REALITY · REPRESENTATIONAL CONTENT · CAUSAL ADEQUACY OR TRADEMARK ROUTE + ONTOLOGICAL ROUTE; PRESENT · INTELLECT JUDGES EXTENDED, FLEXIBLE, CHANGEABLE IDENTITY BEYOND SENSORY QUALITIES · CLEAR/DISTINCT PREMISES PROVE GOD · GOD GUARANTEES CLEAR/DISTINCT TRUTH

DOCTRINE / CLAIM
- COGITO → IDEAS → GOD → NON-DECEPTION → MATHEMATICS AND EXTERNAL RES EXTENSA
- IDEAS: innate / adventitious / factitious; objective reality = representational content
- GOD: causal adequacy or trademark route + ontological route; present cautiously

OBJECTION / PRESSURE
- WAX: intellect judges extended, flexible, changeable identity beyond sensory qualities
- CIRCLE: clear/distinct premises prove God → God guarantees clear/distinct truth
- REPLY: present intuition compels; God secures memory and extended reasoning

REPLY / RESIDUAL
- RESIDUAL: the divine proofs themselves use inferential premises
- WORLD: involuntary sensory ideas require an active cause; veracity blocks deception
- LIMIT: body-existence is stronger than exact resemblance of sensible qualities.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A perfect non-deceiving God is used to guarantee that what is clearly and distinctly perceived remains trustworthy beyond immediate attention.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is the epistemic hinge of Cartesian reconstruction because divine non-deception extends clear and distinct certainty beyond the cogito, yet that hinge creates the Cartesian Circle.

03 DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION AND FREEDOM

STAGE 03

DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION AND FREEDOM · INFINITE SUBSTANCE, ABSOLUTELY INDEPENDENT · RES COGITANS · ATTRIBUTE THOUGHT; MODES INCLUDE IDEAS AND VOLITIONS · RES EXTENSA · ATTRIBUTE EXTENSION; MODES INCLUDE SHAPE AND MOTION · REAL DISTINCTION · CLEAR CONCEPTION OF EACH WITHOUT THE OTHER

GOD = INFINITE SUBSTANCE, ABSOLUTELY INDEPENDENT

RES COGITANS: attribute thought; modes include ideas and volitions → RES EXTENSA: attribute extension; modes include shape and motion → REAL DISTINCTION: clear conception of each without the other

SOURCE / DOCTRINE
- GOD = INFINITE SUBSTANCE, ABSOLUTELY INDEPENDENT
- RES COGITANS: attribute thought; modes include ideas and volitions
- RES EXTENSA: attribute extension; modes include shape and motion
- REAL DISTINCTION: clear conception of each without the other

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM
- SUBSTANTIAL UNION: one embodied person experiences cross-domain coordination
- OBJECTION: how can unextended mind cause extended motion? causal-closure pressure
- REPLY: primitive notion of union; RESIDUAL: no transparent mechanism
- OTHER MINDS: inferred through embodied behaviour, not given by the cogito

IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- FREEDOM: will assents or withholds; error occurs when will outruns intellect
- LIMIT: created substances depend continuously on God.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Clear and distinct conceivability supports real distinction, while the human union is treated as a primitive lived fact rather than a third substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cartesian dualism gains conceptual clarity by separating thought from extension, but its success in distinction becomes its central causal problem because heterogeneous substances must still explain one life.

04 SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND IMMANENT GOD

STAGE 04

SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND IMMANENT GOD · ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE · = DEUS SIVE NATURA INFINITELY MANY ATTRIBUTES HUMANS KNOW · IMMANENT CAUSE; WHATEVER IS, IS IN GOD; NO EXTERNAL · ACOSMISM; REPLY · MODES RETAIN DEPENDENT REALITY.

ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE

= DEUS SIVE NATURA infinitely many ATTRIBUTES humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION finite minds and → GOD = immanent cause; whatever is, is in God; no external created realm → OBJECTION: acosmism; REPLY: modes retain dependent reality.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE
- ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE
- = DEUS SIVE NATURA infinitely many ATTRIBUTES humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION finite minds and bodies are MODES

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM
- GOD = immanent cause; whatever is, is in God; no external created realm
- OBJECTION: acosmism; REPLY: modes retain dependent reality.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE
- = DEUS SIVE NATURA infinitely many ATTRIBUTES humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION finite minds and bodies are MODES

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because substance is conceived through itself and cannot be limited by another substance of the same nature, the system culminates in one infinite substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza radicalises the Cartesian definition of substance until only God or Nature remains self-conceived, making minds and bodies dependent modes rather than independently interacting things.

05 SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE FROM BONDAGE TO FREEDOM

STAGE 05

SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE FROM BONDAGE TO FREEDOM · ONE EVENT · UNDER THOUGHT · UNDER EXTENSION · ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS · ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS · NO CROSS-ATTRIBUTE CAUSAL TRANSFER; PARALLELISM REPLACES CARTESIAN INTERACTION · FINITE MODES ARE NECESSARILY CAUSED; CONTINGENCY RECORDS IGNORANCE OF

ONE EVENT — under THOUGHT: idea — under EXTENSION: body-state

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS → NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction → FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE
- ONE EVENT — under THOUGHT: idea — under EXTENSION: body-state
- ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS
- NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM
- FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes
- CONATUS = each thing's striving to persevere in being
- INADEQUATE IDEAS + external causes → passive affects → BONDAGE

IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- COMMON NOTIONS / REASON / INTUITION → ADEQUATE IDEAS → ACTIVITY
- FREEDOM = acting from understood nature within necessity, not uncaused choice
- LIMIT: autonomy survives, but alternative possibilities do not.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The same modal event is expressed under Thought as an idea and under Extension as a body-state, eliminating cross-attribute causal transfer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza reconciles freedom with determinism by treating freedom not as uncaused choice but as adequate self-determination within the necessary order of God or Nature.

06 LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY

STAGE 06

LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY · WHY MONADS? EXTENSION IS DIVISIBLE; ULTIMATE SUBSTANCE MUST BE · NECESSARY SUPREME MONAD · COMPLETE INTELLIGENCE · RATIONAL SPIRITS · APPERCEPTION + REASON + MORAL AGENCY · ANIMAL SOULS · MEMORY + CLEARER PERCEPTION

WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple

GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence → RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency → ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception

SOURCE / DOCTRINE
- WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple
- GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence
- RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM
- ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception
- BARE MONADS: obscure petites perceptions
- EVERY MONAD: simple, unextended, windowless, perceptive and appetitive

IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- APPETITION = internal transition; each perspective expresses the universe
- IDENTITY OF INDISCERNIBLES secures uniqueness
- BODIES = well-founded phenomena, not ultimate substances.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Appetition moves each monad from one perception to another according to its own law, while its perspective differentiates it from every other monad.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Leibniz makes substance simple and active: each monad is a unique perspectival centre whose internally unfolding perceptions preserve individuality without material parts or causal influx.

07 LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM

STAGE 07

LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM · GOD CHOOSES A COMPOSSIBLE BEST WORLD UNDER THE PRINCIPLE · MIND-MONAD STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY · BODILY/ORGANIC STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY · PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY MAKES THEM CORRESPOND WITHOUT INTERACTION · TRUTHS OF REASON · OPPOSITE CONTRADICTORY · LOGICALLY NECESSARY

GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON

mind-monad states unfold internally → bodily/organic states unfold internally → PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

SOURCE / DOCTRINE
- GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON
- mind-monad states unfold internally
- bodily/organic states unfold internally
- PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM
- TRUTHS OF REASON: opposite contradictory → logically necessary
- TRUTHS OF FACT: opposite conceivable → contingent though certain
- COMPLETE CONCEPT: all predicates belong to the individual known fully by God
- FREEDOM: spontaneity + intelligence + contingency; reasons incline, not coerce

IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- OBJECTION: programming/evil; REPLY: self-expression + optimal compossibility
- LIMIT: compatibility is stronger than libertarian freedom.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — God chooses a compossible world and creates monads whose internally lawful sequences correspond without causal exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Leibniz preserves freedom by distinguishing certainty from absolute necessity: rational actions arise spontaneously from the agent's own reasons, which incline without necessitating in the logical sense.

08 THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

STAGE 08

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES · LEIBNIZ SUBSTANCE · GOD + MIND + BODY · ONE GOD OR NATURE · MANY SIMPLE MONADS · IMMANENT REALITY · SELECTOR/COORDINATOR MIND-BODY · HARMONY ORDER

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
LEIBNIZ substance	selector/coordinator mind-body	rational assent
God + mind + body	harmony order	adequate activity
one God or Nature	mechanism + will	intelligent spontaneity
many simple monads	strict necessity	PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE
- LEIBNIZ substance
- God + mind + body
- one God or Nature
- many simple monads
- immanent reality

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- selector/coordinator mind-body
- harmony order
- mechanism + will
- strict necessity
- certain/contingent freedom

EVALUATION / TRAP
- rational assent
- adequate activity
- intelligent spontaneity
- PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each successor accepts the Cartesian pressure but redistributes substance and causation to avoid direct interaction between heterogeneous realities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza removes the interaction gap by collapsing Cartesian substances into attributes of one order, while Leibniz restores plurality by replacing interaction with divinely coordinated internal activity.

09 CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

STAGE 09

CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE · INTERACTION GAP · PRIMITIVE UNION · MECHANISM REMAINS OPAQUE · ADEQUATE ACTIVITY + MODAL REALITY · NO ALTERNATIVES · SPONTANEITY + POSSIBLE WORLDS · RESIDUAL PRESSURE

DESCARTES: interaction gap → primitive union → mechanism remains opaque → SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism → adequate activity + modal reality → no alternatives → LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy → spontaneity + possible worlds → residual pressure → PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism → PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom

DOCTRINE / CLAIM
- DESCARTES: interaction gap → primitive union → mechanism remains opaque
- SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism → adequate activity + modal reality → no alternatives
- LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy → spontaneity + possible worlds → residual pressure
- PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism

OBJECTION / PRESSURE
- PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom
- PYQ ROUTES: certainty/self-world; substance 3-1-infinity; pantheism; freedom
- PYQ ROUTES: innate ideas; monads/harmony; God; determination/negation
- ANSWER SPINE

REPLY / RESIDUAL
- directive → thesis → definitions → argument → example → objection → reply → verdict
- CONTROL: claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification
- VERDICT: intelligibility is gained at recurring costs to interaction and autonomy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Precision turns system summaries into answers by linking every doctrine to a named inferential role and an explicit qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A criticism-reply answer spine reveals rationalism's central tension: systematic intelligibility repeatedly pressures interaction, contingency and autonomous individuality.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED SESSION 1 — RATIONALISM MASTER MAP AND BASIC · ADVANCED SESSION 2 — CARTESIAN DOUBT, COGITO AND CERTAIN · ADVANCED SESSION 3 — WAX, EXTERNAL WORLD, DIVINE GUARANTEE · ADVANCED SESSION 4 — SUBSTANCE · ONE INHERITED CRITERION, DESCARTES 3, SPINOZA 1, LEIBNIZ INFINITY · ADVANCED SESSION 5 — GOD · CARTESIAN GUARANTEE, SPINOZIST IMMANENT NATURE, LEIBNIZIAN SELECTOR

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS
- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Rationalism Master Map and Basic Tenets
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Cartesian Doubt, Cogito and Certain Self-Knowledge
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Wax, External World, Divine Guarantee and the Cartesian Circle
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Substance: One Inherited Criterion, Descartes 3, Spinoza 1, Leibniz Infinity

ADVANCED OBJECTION
- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — God: Cartesian Guarantee, Spinozist Immanent Nature, Leibnizian Selector
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Mind and Body: Interactionism, Parallelism and Pre-Established Harmony
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Freedom and Determinism Across the Rationalist Trio
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Spinoza's Integrated System: Necessity, Knowledge, Pantheism and Negation

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Leibniz: Monads, Sufficient Reason, Contingency and Harmony
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Criticisms, Comparisons, PYQ Routing and Provenance-Safe Answer Architecture
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- Core prerequisite : finish the owner first for Cartesian Method and Certain Knowledge

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels